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Response for Chicago, 1968: Historical Documents and Final Preparations

This discussion will talk about how protesters against the Vietnam war strategized getting media coverage to show their cause from the text of "Abbie Hoffman, Media Freaking". To start off Abbie Hoffman, in his interview talked about the many ridiculous things he has done and media coverage followed his anti war campaigns. He talks about how tv shows/new stations will not cover a radical idea like his, due to the fact that sponsors with their ads want to target the general audience and don't want their product associated with politics. The idea is to do something absolutely ridiculous and when the media comes show the message. Hoffman has done many things such as acting like a head cop and ordering what they should do, carry large bags of blood out in the streets, swimming in Lake Michigan fully naked, having a sign with "End The", climbing a fence while stoned on acid, paint a word "HIPPE" on a duck, and have the duck poop everywhere, planting a flag on the ground and claiming it for the United States. Although these things look ridiculous and might have people associating the cause to radicalism, it does the job of spreading the word better than the political scholars. Hoffman claims the problem with the left/cause is that there are 10,000 socialist scholars and none of them claim to be socialist. The reason why the protest cannot get media coverage is because the label of socialist is looked down upon in the society of that time.